



BOSTON IS ONE of those cities that sneaks up on you. It doesn't shout its importance, though it absolutely could. After all, it is home to Harvard and MIT (ok, technically the neighbouring town of Cambridge is, but that's a matter of detail). It's also home to the Red Sox and Celtics with an equal number of baseball and basketball fans willing to kill and be killed! And thanks to the Boston Tea Party, every child in the US and a large number outside know all about the American Revolution. But instead of thumping its chest like New York, Boston lets you discover things at your own pace,

as if it knows you'll fall for it eventually. And I did.

The first thing that struck me was how walkable it is. In a country obsessed with cars, Boston feels like it was designed for strolling. The Puritans who laid out the place in 1630 clearly weren't thinking about modern city grids, which is probably why every lane dips and bends. Add cobble stones, and the city feels almost European.

As you walk around, you realise the city doesn't separate history from everyday life. This shows up in sidewalks, old buildings and in plaques embedded around the city.